Cambridge 12
Reading Test 5: Answer Explanation

Test 5: Reading Passage – 1

Cork

Question 1

The cork oak has the thickest bark of any living tree.

Answer: NOT GIVEN

In-depth Explanation

The passage says that the cork oak's bark can grow up to 20 cm thick, but it never compares this thickness with the bark of all other living trees.

Many students quickly choose TRUE because:

- the bark is described as "remarkable"
- it is very thick
- the passage praises the tree repeatedly

But IELTS often uses this trick:

the statement adds a comparison ("thickest of any living tree") that does not appear in the passage.

The passage only gives information about cork oak bark itself — not about every other tree in the world.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
thickest bark	bark grows up to 20 cm in thickness	very thick outer covering
any living tree	no comparison mentioned	comparison trap

Vocabulary Connection

Bark = the outer covering of a tree trunk.

Thickness = how wide something is from one side to another.

Why This Answer is Correct

The statement introduces:

- a superlative comparison ("thickest")

But the passage:

- never confirms this comparison.

So, the answer is NOT GIVEN.

IELTS Trap / Student Mistake

Students often think:

"Very thick" = "thickest"

But IELTS requires:

- exact meaning
- exact comparison

"Thick" does NOT automatically mean "thickest".

IELTS Strategy Tip

When you see:

- best
- most
- only
- always
- never
- all

Check carefully whether the passage REALLY makes that extreme claim.

Question 2

Scientists have developed a synthetic cork with the same cellular structures as natural cork.

Answer: FALSE

In-depth Explanation

The passage clearly says:

"technology has never succeeded in replicating" the cork's cellular structure.

This directly contradicts the question statement.

The question says:

- scientists HAVE developed it

The passage says:

- technology has NEVER succeeded

This is a classic contradiction.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
scientists have developed	technology has never succeeded	opposite meaning

synthetic cork	replicating cork structure	artificial version
same cellular structures	particular cellular structure	same internal arrangement

Vocabulary Connection

Synthetic = artificial; man-made.

Replicate = copy exactly.

Cellular structure = arrangement of tiny cells inside something.

Why This Answer is Correct

The statement and passage say opposite things.

Question:

- successful replication

Passage:

- unsuccessful replication

Therefore → FALSE.

IELTS Trap / Student Mistake

Many students only see:

- "technology"
- "cellular structure"

and stop reading carefully.
But the key word is:
“never”
This single word changes the entire meaning.

IELTS Strategy Tip

Words like:

- never
- no
- failed
- unable
- impossible

often signal FALSE answers.

Question 3

Individual cork oak trees must be left for 25 years between the first and second harvest.

Answer: FALSE

In-depth Explanation

The passage says:

- the FIRST harvest happens 25 years after planting

- AFTER that, harvests happen approximately every 10 years

The question incorrectly changes:
“25 years before first harvest”
into
“25 years between first and second harvest”
This is a timeline distortion trick.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
left for 25 years between harvests	first harvest takes 25 years	incorrect timeline
first and second harvest	approximately a decade between harvests	about 10 years

Vocabulary Connection

Harvest = collecting a natural product from plants or trees.
Approximately = about; nearly.
Why This Answer is Correct
The passage timeline:

- Plant tree
- Wait 25 years → first harvest
- Wait about 10 years → second harvest

The statement changes the timing incorrectly.
Therefore → FALSE.
IELTS Trap / Student Mistake
Students often confuse:

- "before first harvest"
  with
- "between harvests"

IELTS loves testing:

- dates
- sequences
- timelines

IELTS Strategy Tip

Always build a timeline mentally when reading:

- before
- after
- between
- during
- until

These words are extremely important.

Question 4

Cork bark should be stripped in dry atmospheric conditions.

Answer: TRUE

In-depth Explanation

The passage says:

“If the bark is stripped ... when the air is damp – the tree will be damaged.”

This means:

- damp conditions are bad
- therefore dry conditions are needed

The answer is not directly stated using the word “dry”, so students must infer logically.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
dry atmospheric conditions	air is damp	opposite weather condition
should be stripped	if stripped when damp, damage occurs	recommended condition

Vocabulary Connection

Damp = slightly wet or moist.

Atmospheric conditions = weather or air conditions.

Why This Answer is Correct

Passage logic:

- damp air damages trees → therefore harvesting should happen in dry conditions.

So, the statement agrees with the passage.

IELTS Trap / Student Mistake

Students sometimes think:
"dry" is not written directly → NOT GIVEN
But IELTS often tests:

- logical opposite meaning

damp ↔ dry

IELTS Strategy Tip

Learn common opposite paraphrases:

Passage	Question
damp	dry
difficult	not easy
increase	rise
decrease	fall

These are very common in IELTS Reading.

Question 5

The only way to remove the bark from cork oak trees is by hand.

Answer: TRUE

In-depth Explanation

The passage says:
"No mechanical means of stripping cork bark has been invented."

Then it explains:
the job is done by highly skilled workers using axes.
This means:

- machines cannot do it
- humans must do it manually

Therefore, bark removal is done only by hand.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
only way	no mechanical means invented	no alternative method
by hand	highly skilled workers using axes	manual work

Vocabulary Connection

Mechanical means = machines or automated tools.

Strip bark = remove outer tree covering.

Why This Answer is Correct

Passage:

- machines cannot remove bark
- workers do it manually

Therefore:
hand removal is the only method.

IELTS Trap / Student Mistake

Some students choose NOT GIVEN because:

. “by hand” is not written directly.

But the passage clearly implies it through:

- no machines
- workers using axes

This is an inference-based TRUE question.

IELTS Strategy Tip

IELTS often tests:

- implied meaning
  instead of exact wording.

Ask yourself:
“What does this information logically mean?”
That helps a lot in TRUE/FALSE/NOT GIVEN questions.

Question 6

do not affect the _____ of the bottle contents

Answer: taste

In-depth Explanation

The passage explains that cork can sometimes spoil the taste of the product because of a chemical compound called TCA. Aluminium screw caps do not have this problem.

This means:

- screw caps protect the taste
- cork may damage the taste

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
do not affect	can spoil	opposite effect
bottle contents	product contained in the bottle	liquid/product inside
taste	taste	flavour

Vocabulary Connection

Spoil = damage quality or flavour.

Contents = things inside something.

Why This Answer is Correct

The passage directly links cork problems with: "spoil the taste"

So, the missing word is:

taste

IELTS Trap / Student Mistake

Students may wrongly write:

- flavour
- product
- quality

But IELTS requires:

- ONE WORD ONLY
- exact word from passage

IELTS Strategy Tip

In summary completion:

- answers usually appear in order
- look for exact noun connections nearby

Question 7

are _____ to produce

Answer: cheaper

In-depth Explanation

The passage says:

"These substitutes are cheaper to manufacture"

"Manufacture" means "produce".

So:

- cheaper to manufacture = cheaper to produce

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
cheaper to produce	cheaper to manufacture	lower production cost

Vocabulary Connection

Manufacture = produce in factories.

Why This Answer is Correct

The summary directly paraphrases:

cheaper to manufacture

IELTS Trap / Student Mistake

Some students write:

- cheap
- easily
- inexpensive

But grammatically:

are _____ to produce

needs an adjective: **cheaper**

IELTS Strategy Tip

Always check grammar carefully:

- adjective?
- noun?
- verb?

Grammar helps identify the correct answer.

Question 8

are _____ to use

Answer: convenient

In-depth Explanation

The passage states:

“screw caps [are] more convenient for the user”

The summary shortens:

convenient for the user
to
convenient to use

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
convenient to use	convenient for the user	easy/practical

Vocabulary Connection

Convenient = easy and practical to use.

Why This Answer is Correct

The summary uses almost the same wording as the passage.

IELTS Trap / Student Mistake

Students sometimes write:

- easier
- simple
- useful

But the exact passage word is:

convenient

IELTS Strategy Tip

For note completion:

- exact passage vocabulary is often safest

Question 9

suit the _____ of quality products

Answer: image

In-depth Explanation

The passage says:

“its traditional image is more in keeping with high quality goods”

This means cork matches the image or reputation of premium products.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
suit the image	traditional image is in keeping with	matches reputation/style
quality products	high quality goods	premium items

Vocabulary Connection

Image = public impression or appearance.

Why This Answer is Correct

The question paraphrases:

"**in keeping with**" (Means: ***means to be consistent, harmonious, or in agreement with something (like rules, traditions, or values)***)

as

"**suit**"

IELTS Trap / Student Mistake

Students may wrongly choose:

- tradition
- quality
- goods

But grammatically and logically:

suit the image of quality products

fits perfectly.

IELTS Strategy Tip

Watch for:

- synonym verbs

Passage	Question
in keeping with	suit
assist	help
prevent	stop

Question 10

made from a _____ material

Answer: sustainable

In-depth Explanation

The passage directly says:

“cork is a sustainable product”

This is one of cork’s major environmental advantages.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
made from a ... material	cork is a sustainable product	environmentally renewable

Vocabulary Connection

Sustainable = can continue for a long time without harming the environment.

Why This Answer is Correct

The wording is almost directly copied from the passage.

IELTS Trap / Student Mistake

Students sometimes write:

- recycled
- natural
- environmental

But the passage specifically emphasises:

sustainable

IELTS Strategy Tip

Environmental vocabulary is very common in IELTS:

- sustainable
- recyclable
- renewable
- biodegradable

Learn these carefully.

Question 11

easily _____

Answer: recycled

In-depth Explanation

The passage says:

“cork is a sustainable product that can be recycled without difficulty”

“Without difficulty”

“easily”

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
easily recycled	recycled without difficulty	simple to recycle

Vocabulary Connection

Recycle = process materials so they can be used again.

Why This Answer is Correct

The summary converts the phrase into a shorter form.

IELTS Trap / Student Mistake

Some students incorrectly write:

- reused
- reused easily

But:

- ONE WORD ONLY
- exact passage wording matters

IELTS Strategy Tip

Adverbs often paraphrase phrases:

Passage	Question
without difficulty	easily
at low cost	cheaply

Question 12

cork forests support local 12 _____

Answer: biodiversity

In-depth Explanation

The passage explains that cork forests help many different plants and animals survive together naturally.

The exact line says:

“support local biodiversity”

So, the summary directly copies the key noun.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
support local	support local	help/protect nearby
biodiversity	biodiversity	variety of plants and animals

Vocabulary Connection

Biodiversity = the variety of living organisms in an environment.

Why This Answer is Correct

The wording is almost exactly the same as the passage.

IELTS Trap / Student Mistake

Students sometimes overthink and search for:

- animals
- wildlife
- ecosystem

But IELTS often uses:
direct copying for note completion.

IELTS Strategy Tip

If the note sentence structure perfectly matches the passage,
the answer is often copied directly.

Question 13

cork forests stop 13 _____ happening

Answer: desertification

In-depth Explanation

The passage says cork forests:
"prevent desertification"
The summary changes:

- prevent → stop
- but keeps the same meaning.

Desertification means fertile land slowly turning into desert because of drought, heat, or environmental damage.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
stop happening	prevent	stop from occurring
desertification	desertification	land becoming desert

Vocabulary Connection

Desertification = the process where land becomes dry and infertile like a desert.

Why This Answer is Correct

The sentence becomes:
cork forests stop desertification happening
which is grammatically and logically correct.

IELTS Trap / Student Mistake

Many students mistakenly choose:

biodiversity
because they see it nearby in the passage.
But:
❌ stop biodiversity happening
sounds grammatically wrong.
IELTS often places:

- the correct answer
  near
- another attractive wrong word

This is called a:
distractor trap.

Test 5: Reading Passage - 2

COLLECTING AS A HOBBY

Question 14

The writer mentions collecting _____ as an example of collecting in order to make money.

Answer: antiques

In-depth Explanation

The passage explains that some people collect items mainly to make a profit. The writer gives the example of people buying antiques cheaply and later selling them at a higher price.

This shows:

- collecting can be business-related
- some collectors focus on financial gain instead of personal enjoyment

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
collecting in order to make money	buy cheaply and sell at a profit	financial purpose
example	say, antiques	sample item

Vocabulary Connection

Antiques = old valuable objects collected because of age or rarity.

Profit = money gained from selling something.

Why This Answer is Correct

The passage directly states:

"They'll look for, say, antiques…"

So, the answer is copied directly from the passage.

IELTS Trap / Student Mistake

Students sometimes write:

- money
- profit
- postcards

But the question asks for:

an example of something collected

not the reason.

IELTS Strategy Tip

For note completion:

- identify whether the blank needs:
  - ✓ an object
  - ✓ person
  - ✓ action

✓ idea

Grammar helps locate the answer faster.

Question 15

Collectors may get a feeling of _____ from buying and selling items.

Answer: triumph

In-depth Explanation

The writer says collectors may experience emotional satisfaction when they successfully buy cheaply and sell at a profit.

The passage directly says:

“can give the collector a sense of triumph”

This highlights:

- emotional reward
- psychological satisfaction

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
feeling	sense	emotional state

buying and selling items	buying cheap and selling dear	trading activity
triumph	triumph	success/victory

Vocabulary Connection

Triumph = a strong feeling of success or victory.

Why This Answer is Correct

The summary paraphrases:

"**sense of triumph**"

as

"**feeling of triumph**"

IELTS Trap / Student Mistake

Students may incorrectly choose:

- profit
- happiness
- success

But IELTS usually prefers:

exact passage vocabulary.

IELTS Strategy Tip

When the passage and question structure are very similar,
copying the exact noun is often safest.

Question 16

Collectors' clubs provide opportunities to share _____

Answer: information

In-depth Explanation

The passage explains that collectors attend meetings and exchange information about collected items.

This means clubs help people:

- learn from each other
- discuss collections
- share knowledge

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
provide opportunities to share	exchanging	giving and receiving
information	information	knowledge/details

Vocabulary Connection

Exchange = give and receive mutually.

Why This Answer is Correct

The passage directly states:

"exchanging information"

IELTS Trap / Student Mistake

Students sometimes write:

- ideas
- knowledge
- items

But the exact word used is:

information

IELTS Strategy Tip

In sentence completion:

- repeated exact nouns are common answer locations.

Question 17

Collectors' clubs offer _____ with people who have similar interests.

Answer: contact/meetings

In-depth Explanation

The writer compares collectors' clubs to bridge clubs or gyms because they bring people into contact with others who share similar interests.

The focus here is:

- social interaction
- meeting like-minded people

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
offer	brings	create/provide
people who have similar interests	like-minded people	similar-thinking people
contact	contact	social connection

Vocabulary Connection

Like-minded = having similar interests or opinions.

Why This Answer is Correct

The passage directly says:

"brings them into contact with like-minded people"

IELTS Trap / Student Mistake

Students may choose:

- friendship
- groups

But grammatically:

offer _____ with people

best fits:

contact

IELTS Strategy Tip

Always test the completed sentence naturally after choosing the answer.

Question 18

Collecting sometimes involves a life-long _____ for a special item.

Answer: hunt/desire

In-depth Explanation

The passage says some collectors spend their whole lives searching for a rare item.

The exact phrase is:

“spend their whole lives in a hunt”

This shows:

- long-term dedication

- obsession
- personal mission

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
life-long	whole lives	entire lifetime
search for	hunt for	try to find

Vocabulary Connection

Hunt = a determined search for something difficult to find.

Why This Answer is Correct

The summary directly paraphrases:
whole lives in a hunt

IELTS Trap / Student Mistake

Students may incorrectly write:

- search
- desire
- goal

But IELTS requires:
ONE WORD ONLY from the passage.

IELTS Strategy Tip

If two synonyms appear,
IELTS usually wants the exact passage word.

Question 19

Searching for something particular may prevent people from feeling their life is completely _____

Answer: aimless/empty

In-depth Explanation

The writer explains that searching for rare items can give purpose to life.

The passage says:

“a life that otherwise feels aimless”

Meaning:

- without direction
- without goals

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
prevent people from feeling	give purpose to	stop emptiness

completely aimless	feels aimless	lacking direction

Vocabulary Connection

Aimless = having no purpose or direction.

Why This Answer is Correct

The summary reverses the idea logically:

- **collecting gives purpose → therefore life does not feel aimless.**

IELTS Trap / Student Mistake

Students sometimes choose:

- empty
- meaningless
- lonely

But the exact passage word is:

aimless

IELTS Strategy Tip

Notice logical opposites:

- give purpose ↔ not aimless

IELTS often tests this skill

Question 20

Stamp collecting may be _____ because it provides facts about different countries.

Answer: educational

In-depth Explanation

The passage explains that stamp collecting teaches people about:

- countries
- animals
- famous people
- geography

So, collecting stamps can be educational.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
provides facts	opens a window to	gives knowledge
educational	educational value	teaching benefit

Vocabulary Connection

Educational = helping people learn.

Why This Answer is Correct

The passage directly says:
“educational value”

IELTS Trap / Student Mistake

Students may choose:

- informative
- useful
- interesting

But IELTS usually prefers the exact keyword.

IELTS Strategy Tip

Words ending in:

- tion
- sion
- al

often appear in IELTS academic summaries.

Question 21

_____ tends to be mostly a male hobby.

Answer: trainspotting

In-depth Explanation

The passage says:

"a popular form of collecting, particularly among boys and men, was trainspotting."

So, trainspotting is described as mainly male.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
mostly a male hobby	particularly among boys and men	mainly done by males

Vocabulary Connection

Trainspotting = recording and identifying trains as a hobby.

Why This Answer is Correct

The wording directly matches the passage meaning.

IELTS Trap / Student Mistake

Students sometimes write:

- trains
- locomotives
- collecting trains

But the hobby name itself is:

trainspotting

IELTS Strategy Tip

If the passage introduces:

"a hobby called…"

that full hobby name is often the answer.

Question 22

The number of people buying dolls has grown over the centuries.

Answer: NOT GIVEN

In-depth Explanation

The passage discusses:

- materials used for dolls changing over time

But it never mentions:

- how many people bought dolls
- whether numbers increased

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
number of people buying dolls	no sales/population data	missing information
grown over centuries	materials changed over centuries	different topic

Vocabulary Connection

Century = 100 years.

Why This Answer is Correct

The statement introduces:

- popularity growth

But the passage discusses:

- material development only.

IELTS Trap / Student Mistake

Students often confuse:

- "more information about dolls"
  with
- "more people buying dolls"

IELTS Strategy Tip

Always check:

Is the SAME topic being discussed?

Related topic ≠ same answer.

Question 23

Sixteenth century European dolls were normally made of wax and porcelain.

Answer: FALSE

In-depth Explanation

The passage says:

wood was standard in 16th century Europe

Wax and porcelain appeared later.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
16th century dolls	16th century Europe	same period
wax and porcelain	wood was standard	contradiction

Vocabulary Connection

Porcelain = hard decorative ceramic material.

Why This Answer is Correct

The statement changes the historical material incorrectly.

IELTS Trap / Student Mistake

Students may see:

- wax
- porcelain

and miss:

- “later centuries”

Timeline traps are extremely common in IELTS.

IELTS Strategy Tip

Watch carefully for:

- dates

- centuries
- before/after relationships

Question 24

Arranging a stamp collection by the size of the stamps is less common than other methods.

Answer: NOT GIVEN

In-depth Explanation

The passage gives examples of common arrangements:

- by country
- alphabetically
- by theme

But it never discusses:

- arranging by size
- whether size is less common

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
size of stamps	no mention	missing detail
less common	no comparison	absent information

Vocabulary Connection

Depict = show or represent visually.

Why This Answer is Correct

The statement introduces a comparison not mentioned in the passage.

IELTS Trap / Student Mistake

Students may think:

because size is not mentioned → FALSE

But:

- ***absence of information = NOT GIVEN***

IELTS Strategy Tip

FALSE = direct contradiction

NOT GIVEN = information missing

Never confuse these two.

Question 25

Someone who collects unusual objects may want others to think he or she is also unusual.

Answer: TRUE

In-depth Explanation

The passage says collecting unusual items may show the collector believes they are interesting themselves.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
unusual objects	unexpected items	uncommon things
think he/she is unusual	must be interesting themselves	unique personality

Vocabulary Connection

Individualism = expressing uniqueness or individuality.

Why This Answer is Correct

The statement accurately paraphrases the writer's idea.

IELTS Trap / Student Mistake

Students may hesitate because:

- "unusual" is not written directly

But:

- unexpected
- interesting

- individualism

all support the same idea.

IELTS Strategy Tip

IELTS often tests:

- idea equivalence
  not exact wording.

Question 26

Collecting gives a feeling that other hobbies are unlikely to inspire.

Answer: TRUE

In-depth Explanation

The final paragraph says:

“More than most other hobbies, collecting can be totally engrossing, and can give a strong sense of personal fulfilment.”

This directly compares collecting with other hobbies.

The writer clearly believes:

- collecting creates a stronger emotional effect
  than
- many other hobbies.

That is why the answer is TRUE.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
gives a feeling	give a strong sense of personal fulfilment	emotional satisfaction
other hobbies are unlikely to inspire	more than most other hobbies	stronger effect than others

Vocabulary Connection

Engrossing = extremely interesting and absorbing.

Fulfilment = deep personal satisfaction.

Why This Answer is Correct

The key phrase is:

“More than most other hobbies”
This directly supports the comparison in the question.
So:

- collecting inspires stronger feelings than
- many other hobbies.

IELTS Trap / Student Mistake
Students often miss:
comparative phrases
especially:

- more than
- less than
- unlike
- most

These words are extremely important in TRUE/FALSE/NOT GIVEN questions.
IELTS Strategy Tip
Whenever you see comparison words in the question:

- better

- stronger
- more likely
- less common

immediately scan the passage for:

- comparative structures

because IELTS usually hides the answer there.

Test 5: Reading Passage – 3

What's the purpose of gaining knowledge?

Question 27

Correct Answer: vi

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph A focuses on the idea that universities today offer instruction in almost every subject imaginable. The writer gives examples of many different career-focused programs and then introduces the shocking course title "Arson for Profit".

The MAIN idea is:

modern education allows people to study almost anything.

That matches Heading vi.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Heading Idea	Passage Words	Meaning
wide range of education	“instruction in any subject”	education without limitation
many subjects available	“resort management, engineering, interior design…”	huge variety

Vocabulary Connection

Institution = organization such as a university.

Why students make mistakes here

Students often choose headings based on:

- shocking examples (“Arson for Profit”)

But headings test:

the MAIN CENTRAL IDEA of the whole paragraph.

The arson course is only an example supporting the bigger idea.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS uses:

distractor detail trap

A memorable example distracts students from the paragraph's true focus.

Question 28

Correct Answer: viii

Why is this answer correct?

This paragraph discusses how useful professional knowledge can also be misused by criminals.

The writer explains:

- the course is meant for investigators
  BUT
- arsonists could also benefit from it.

The paragraph's key idea is:
education can sometimes support unethical behavior.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Heading Idea	Passage Words	Meaning
misuse of knowledge	"perfect course for prospective arsonists"	criminal misuse
illegal behavior	"dishonest and illegal behavior"	unethical actions

Vocabulary Connection

Prospective = future or potential.

Why students make mistakes here

Students often focus only on:

- firefighting
- investigation

But the paragraph is actually about:
ethical danger.

IELTS Trick Used Here

The paragraph begins positively,
then suddenly shifts to ethical concern.
IELTS often hides the main idea:

- in the middle
  or
- near the end of the paragraph.

Question 29

Correct Answer: ii

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph C introduces the philosophical debate:
Can marketing be ethical?
The writer focuses heavily on:

- “principles”
  vs
- “principled”

Meaning:

- rules
  vs
- morality

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Heading Idea	Passage Words	Meaning
ethical debate	“Is marketing principled?”	morality question
principles vs ethics	“codified” vs “ethical”	rules vs morality

Vocabulary Connection

Principled = morally correct.

Codified = organized into rules.

Why students make mistakes here

Students often confuse:

- technical principles
  with
- moral principles.

The paragraph is NOT about marketing techniques.

It is about:

ethics.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS intentionally uses:

- same root words with different meanings

Example:

- principles
- principled

This confuses many students.

Question 30

Correct Answer: iv

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph D introduces Kant's philosophical idea:

all knowledge contains both:

- means
- ends

The paragraph is short but highly theoretical.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Heading Idea	Passage Words	Meaning
philosophical theory	"Kant argued"	philosopher's concept
means and ends	"purpose and means"	methods and goals

Vocabulary Connection

End = final goal or purpose.

Means = method used to achieve something.

Why students make mistakes here

Students often incorrectly choose headings about:

- marketing

But marketing is only mentioned briefly.

The true focus is:

Kant's theory itself.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS often places:

- example topic
  next to
- main theoretical idea.

Students choose the example instead of the theory.

Question 31

Correct Answer: iii

Why is this answer correct?

This paragraph explains that students should examine BOTH:

- how to achieve something
  AND

- whether the goal itself is worthwhile.

The writer rejects two simplistic attitudes:

1. marketing is only about money
2. purpose does not matter

The paragraph's central message is:
means and goals must both be evaluated carefully.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Heading Idea	Passage Words	Meaning
importance of goals	"what X is"	defining the purpose
both means and ends matter	"both deserve scrutiny"	both need examination

Vocabulary Connection

Scrutiny = close careful examination.

Why students make mistakes here

Students often focus only on:

- marketing examples

But the real idea is:
educational purpose and ethics.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS hides the true heading inside abstract sentences like:

“both deserve scrutiny”
These are usually the key sentences.

Question 32

Correct Answer: vii

Why is this answer correct?

This paragraph applies Kant’s theory to real-life professions.

The writer explains:

- same knowledge
  can produce
- completely different moral outcomes.

Examples:

- firefighter vs arsonist
- doctor vs poisoner
- marketing vs fraud

The key idea is:
morality depends on purpose.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Heading Idea	Passage Words	Meaning
same knowledge, different purpose	“identical knowledge”	same skills

ethical difference	“medicine” vs “murder”	moral contrast

Vocabulary Connection

Fraud = dishonest deception for gain.

Why students make mistakes here

Students often think:

- this paragraph is only about arson.

Actually, arson is just ONE example.

The paragraph’s broader message is:

ethical use of knowledge.

IELTS Trick Used Here

Final paragraphs often:

- summarize
- apply earlier theories
- combine multiple examples

Students should focus on:

the repeated central theme,

not individual examples.

Question 33

This is a university course intended for students who are undergraduates and who are studying

_____

Answer: fire science

Why is this answer correct?

The passage directly says:

"our program in '**fire science**'"

The summary paraphrases:

- **"program" → "studying"**
- but keeps the same academic subject.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
studying	program in	academic subject
university course	course in fire science	educational field

Vocabulary Connection

Fire science = the academic study of fire prevention, investigation, and safety.

Why students make mistakes here

Students sometimes write:

- arson
- firefighting

But the question asks:

what subject are the undergraduates studying?

The exact academic field is:

fire science

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS often paraphrases:

- "program"
  as
- "studying"

Students must recognize academic synonyms.

Question 34

The expectation is that they will become _____ specialising in arson.

Answer: investigators

Why is this answer correct?

The passage clearly states:

"the course is intended for prospective arson investigators"

Meaning:

- future investigators specializing in arson crimes.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
expectation	prospective	future intention
specialising in arson	arson investigators	fire-crime specialists

Vocabulary Connection

Investigator = a person who officially examines crimes or incidents.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may incorrectly choose:

- firefighters
- police
- lawyers

But the passage specifically mentions:
arson investigators

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS removes descriptive words:

- "arson investigators"
  becomes simply:
- "investigators specialising in arson"

Question 35

The course will help them to detect cases of arson and find _____ of criminal intent

Answer: evidence

Why is this answer correct?

The passage says:
"establishing a chain of evidence"
This evidence helps prove:

- criminal intention
- deliberate fire-setting

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
find	establish	discover/build
criminal intent	deliberately set	intentional crime
evidence	evidence	proof

Vocabulary Connection

Evidence = facts or proof showing something is true.

Why students make mistakes here

Some students write:

- proof
- chain
- intent

But IELTS requires:

exact passage vocabulary.

IELTS Trick Used Here

The question changes grammar slightly:

- “**chain of evidence**”
  → “**find evidence**”

Students must identify the core noun.

Question 36

leading to successful _____ in the courts.

Answer: prosecution

Why is this answer correct?

The passage says:

“effective prosecution in a court of law”

Meaning:

- successful legal action against criminals.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
successful	effective	producing desired result
in the courts	court of law	legal system
prosecution	prosecution	criminal legal process

Vocabulary Connection

Prosecution = the legal process of officially charging someone with a crime.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may incorrectly write:

- conviction
- punishment

- trial

But the passage specifically uses:
prosecution

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS often paraphrases adjectives:

- effective
  → successful

while keeping the core noun unchanged.

Question 37

It is difficult to attract students onto courses that do not focus on a career.

Answer: NOT GIVEN

Why is this answer correct?

The passage mentions many career-focused university programs, but it never discusses:

- whether non-career courses are difficult to promote
- student enrollment problems

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Idea	Passage Reality	Meaning
difficult to attract students	not discussed	missing information
courses without career focus	no comparison mentioned	absent idea

Vocabulary Connection

Focus on a career = prepare students for a profession.

Why students make mistakes here

Students often assume:

because many career courses are mentioned,
non-career courses must be unpopular.

But IELTS requires:

direct evidence.

IELTS Trick Used Here

This is a classic:

assumption trap

The statement sounds logical,
but the writer never actually says it.

Question 38

The '**Arson for Profit**' course would be useful for people intending to set fire to buildings.

Answer: YES

Why is this answer correct?

The writer directly says:

"wouldn't this also be the perfect course for prospective arsonists?"

This clearly shows agreement with the statement.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
useful for people intending to set fires	perfect course for prospective arsonists	useful for criminals

Vocabulary Connection

Arsonist = someone who deliberately starts fires illegally.

Why students make mistakes here

Students sometimes think:

- the writer is only asking a rhetorical question

But the writer clearly implies agreement.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS sometimes hides YES answers inside:

- rhetorical questions instead of direct statements.

Question 39

Fire science courses are too academic to help people to be good at the job of firefighting.

Answer: NO

Why is this answer correct?

The writer actually supports these courses and says:
“they are highly welcome”
The writer believes they help professionalize the occupation.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
too academic	professionalization	opposite idea
not helpful	highly welcome	useful/positive

Vocabulary Connection

Professionalization = making an occupation more skilled and formally trained.

Why students make mistakes here

Students confuse:

- ethical concerns with
- criticism of the courses themselves.

But the writer supports the programs overall.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS mixes:

- criticism of misuse
  with
- support for the subject itself.

Students must separate the two ideas carefully.

Question 40

The writer's fire science students provided a detailed definition of the purpose of their studies.

Answer: NO

Why is this answer correct?

The passage says students:

"eventually generalize to something like…"

This means:

- their answer was broad
- not detailed or precise.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
detailed definition	generalize to something like	opposite meaning
purpose of their studies	purpose of their field	same concept

Vocabulary Connection

Generalize = speak in broad, non-specific terms.

Why students make mistakes here

Students often focus only on:

- students gave a definition

But ignore:

- the quality of the definition.

The key word is:

detailed

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS often changes answers using:

- adjective precision

Example:

- detailed ↔ generalized

A single adjective completely changes the answer.

Cambridge 12
Reading Test 6: Answer Explanation

Test 6: Reading Passage – 1

The risks agriculture faces in developing countries

Question 1

a reference to characteristics that only apply to food production

Answer: A

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph A explains that food production is different from every other productive activity because:

1. everyone needs food every day
2. food production depends heavily on nature

These are described as:

"Two things distinguish food production from all other productive activities"

So, this paragraph clearly discusses:

unique characteristics of food production.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
characteristics that only apply	"distinguish food production"	special features

only apply to food production	“different from any other business”	unique qualities

Vocabulary Connection

Distinguish = make something different from others.

Entrenched = strongly established and difficult to change.

Why students make mistakes here

Students sometimes choose:

- Paragraph B

because it also talks about farming problems.

But Paragraph A specifically focuses on:

what makes food production unique.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS uses:

broad concept vs specific problem trap

Paragraph A = unique nature of agriculture

Paragraph B = challenges farmers face

Question 2

a reference to challenges faced only by farmers in certain parts of the world

Answer: B

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph B explains that:

- all farmers face risks
  BUT
- smallholder farmers in developing countries face additional difficulties.

These include:

- poor soil
- weak infrastructure
- lack of finance
- limited technology

So, the paragraph discusses:
special challenges affecting farmers in developing countries only.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
certain parts of the world	"developing countries"	specific global regions

challenges faced only by	"must in addition deal with"	extra problems

Vocabulary Connection

Smallholder farmers = farmers working on small farms.

Adverse = harmful or unfavorable.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may focus only on:

- climate risks

But the key phrase is:

"in addition"

which shows:

- these farmers face extra difficulties.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS hides the answer inside:

- comparison structures

Example:

- all farmers face risks
  BUT
- developing-country farmers face additional difficulties

Question 3

a reference to difficulties in bringing about co-operation between farmers

Answer: H

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph H discusses:

- collective action groups
- co-operatives
- producers' groups

But it also says:

"It takes time, effort and money to organise, build trust and to experiment."

This clearly shows:

cooperation is difficult to achieve.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
difficulties in bringing about co-operation	"takes time, effort and money to organise"	hard to create collaboration
co-operation between farmers	"collective action groups"	working together

Vocabulary Connection

Collective action = people working together toward a shared goal.

Why students make mistakes here

Students often focus only on:

- advantages of co-operatives

But the question asks about:
difficulties.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS often places:

- positive information first
  then
- challenges afterward.

The actual answer is usually near:

- contrast words
  like:
- however
- but
- warned

Question 4

Financial assistance from the government does not always go to the farmers who most need it.

Answer: D (Rokeya Kabir)

Why is this answer correct?

Rokeya Kabir says:

“sixty percent of beneficiaries of subsidies are not poor”

Meaning:

- rich landowners often receive support instead of poor farmers.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
financial assistance from government	subsidies	government financial help
farmers who most need it	poor farmers	needy farmers
does not always go to	beneficiaries are not poor	wrongly distributed

Vocabulary Connection

Subsidy = money given by government to support people or industries.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may wrongly choose:

- Fan

because he discusses poverty.

But Kabir specifically criticizes:

unfair subsidy distribution.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS paraphrases:

- subsidies
  → financial assistance

Students must recognize economic synonyms.

Question 5

Farmers can benefit from collaborating as a group.

Answer: B (Sophia Murphy)

Why is this answer correct?

Murphy says:

"collective action offers an important way for farmers to strengthen their political and economic bargaining power"

Meaning:

- cooperation benefits farmers.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
collaborating as a group	collective action	working together
can benefit	strengthen bargaining power	gain advantages

Vocabulary Connection

Bargaining power = ability to negotiate successfully.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may choose:

- Giel Ton

because he discusses collective action too.

But Ton mainly discusses:

difficulties organizing groups.

Murphy focuses on:

benefits.

IELTS Trick Used Here

Multiple people discuss the same topic, but from different perspectives.

Question 6

Financial assistance from the government can improve the standard of living of farmers.

Answer: C (Shenggen Fan)

Why is this answer correct?

Fan supports:

“social safety nets and public welfare programmes”

because they help:

- reduce poverty

- reduce vulnerability

This improves farmers' living conditions.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
financial assistance	welfare programmes	economic support
improve standard of living	address poverty	improve life conditions

Vocabulary Connection

Vulnerability = risk of suffering harm or difficulty.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may confuse:

- Fan's positive opinion
  with
- criticism from later commentators.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS sometimes places:

- supporting opinion
  then
- criticism afterward.

Students must separate viewpoints carefully.

Question 7

Farmers may be helped if there is financial input by the same individuals who buy from them.

Answer: G (Sonali Bisht)

Why is this answer correct?

Bisht describes:

"community-supported agriculture"

where:

- consumers invest in local farmers
- consumers guarantee fair prices

Meaning:

- buyers financially support producers.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
financial input	invest by subscription	money contribution
same individuals who buy from them	consumers invest in farmers	buyers support producers

Vocabulary Connection

Subscription = regular payment to support a service or activity.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may incorrectly focus on:

- direct selling

But the key idea is:
consumers financially investing.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS changes:

- consumers
  into
- individuals who buy from them

This is a people-description paraphrase.

Question 8

Governments can help to reduce variation in prices.

Answer: B (Sophia Murphy)

Why is this answer correct?

Murphy explains that governments can:
hold food stocks
to reduce:
“wild swings in food prices”
Meaning:

- governments can reduce price volatility.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning

reduce variation in prices	mitigate wild swings in food prices	stabilize prices

Vocabulary Connection

Volatility = frequent and unpredictable change.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may choose:

- Nwanze

because he discusses government support too.

But Murphy specifically discusses:

price control.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS replaces:

- wild swings

  with

- variation

Students must recognize meaning similarity.

Question 9

Improvements to infrastructure can have a major impact on risk for farmers.

Answer: A (Kanayo F. Nwanze)

Why is this answer correct?

Nwanze argues governments should provide:

- roads

- water systems
- storage facilities

because these reduce farmers' risks.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
improvements to infrastructure	roads, water, storage facilities	physical systems
major impact on risk	significantly reduce risks	lower danger/problems

Vocabulary Connection

Infrastructure = basic systems like roads, transport, and storage.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may focus only on:

- roads

But the broader idea is:
infrastructure support reduces risk.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS summarizes multiple examples into one abstract term:

- roads + storage + water
  → infrastructure.

Question 10 & 11

Which TWO problems are mentioned which affect farmers with small farms in developing countries?

Answer: D, E

- **D = the effects of changing weather patterns**
- **E = having to sell their goods to intermediary buyers**

Why is answer D correct?

Paragraph G explains that:

"The growing unpredictability of weather patterns increases farmers' difficulty…"

This directly refers to:

- changing climate
- extreme weather
- unpredictable farming conditions

These problems especially affect:

- small-scale farmers in developing countries.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
changing weather patterns	unpredictability of weather patterns	unstable climate
effects	increases difficulty	creates problems

Vocabulary Connection

Unpredictability = impossible to accurately forecast.

Why students make mistakes here

Students sometimes choose:

- irrigation problems

because water is mentioned elsewhere.

But the question specifically asks:

problems affecting farmers.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS paraphrases:

- unpredictability → changing patterns

Why is answer E correct?

Paragraph I explains that:

intermediary purchasers dictate prices

This means:

- farmers are forced to sell through middlemen
- these buyers control prices unfairly

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
intermediary buyers	intermediary purchasers	middlemen
sell their goods	dictate prices	forced selling system

Vocabulary Connection

Intermediary = middle person between producer and buyer.

Why students make mistakes here

Students often choose:

- lack of demand for local food

But the passage never says demand is low.

The issue is:

unfair selling structure.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS changes:

- purchasers → buyers

Simple synonym replacement trap.

Why is this answer correct?

Both problems are directly discussed in:

- Paragraph G
- Paragraph I

These problems increase:

- farmer vulnerability
- financial instability
- agricultural risk

IELTS Strategy Tip

For multiple-choice "TWO answers" questions:

1. Eliminate options NOT directly mentioned
2. Look for exact evidence
3. Don't choose logical assumptions

Question 12 & 13

Question

Which TWO actions are recommended for improving conditions for farmers?

Answer: C, D

- **C = organising co-operation between a wide range of interested parties**
- **D = encouraging consumers to take a financial stake in farming**

Why is answer C correct?

In-depth Explanation

Paragraph H says:

"all stakeholders, including business, government, scientists and civil society, must work together"

This clearly recommends:

- broad cooperation
- multiple groups working together

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
organising co-operation	work together	collaboration
wide range of interested parties	stakeholders including business, government, scientists	many groups

Vocabulary Connection

Stakeholders = people or groups affected by something.

Why students make mistakes here

Students sometimes choose:

- reducing food stocks

because stocks are discussed earlier.
But the question asks:
recommended actions for improvement.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS summarizes a long stakeholder list into:
"wide range of interested parties"

Why is answer D correct?

In-depth Explanation

Paragraph I describes:
"community-supported agriculture"
where consumers:

- invest in local farmers
- support farming financially

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
consumers take financial stake	consumers invest by subscription	financial involvement
farming	local farmers	agricultural support

Vocabulary Connection

Subscription = regular financial contribution.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may focus only on:

- fair prices

But the key idea is:

consumers financially supporting farms.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS paraphrases:

- invest → take a financial stake

This is a common business-style synonym.

Why is this answer correct?

Both actions aim to:

- reduce risk
- improve stability
- strengthen support systems for farmers

IELTS Strategy Tip

For "Choose TWO letters" questions:

- each correct option must be explicitly supported
- avoid answers based only on logic or outside knowledge

Always ask:

"Where exactly is this stated in the passage?"

Test 6: Reading Passage – 2

The Lost City

Question 14

Paragraph A

Answer: iv

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph A mainly explains:

- why Bingham travelled to Peru
- what he hoped to discover

His goal was:

"to locate the remains of a city called Vitcos"

So, the paragraph focuses on:

the purpose of the expedition.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Heading Idea	Passage Words	Meaning
aim of the trip	"His goal was to locate…"	purpose of journey

Vocabulary Connection

Hinterland = remote inland area far from cities.

Why students make mistakes here

Students often choose headings related to:

- the valley route

because much of the paragraph describes geography.

But the MAIN idea is:

Bingham's mission.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS includes:

- supporting travel details around
- the actual main idea.

Question 15

Paragraph B

Answer: vi

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph B explains that Bingham used:

a newly created track

Unlike earlier travellers,
his team followed:
a different route through the valley.
This new route allowed him to pass near Machu Picchu.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Heading Idea	Passage Words	Meaning
new route	"track had recently been blasted"	newly created path
different journey path	"Almost all previous travellers…"	unusual route

Vocabulary Connection

Blasted = created using explosives.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may choose:

- "Different accounts of the same journey"

because the paragraph compares travellers.
But the focus is:
the route itself.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS often compares:

- ***old method vs new method***

The heading usually matches:
the contrast.

Question 16

Paragraph C

Answer: viii

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph C emphasizes that Bingham was:

- tired
- unenthusiastic
- not expecting anything important

The passage says:

“without having the least expectation”

So, the paragraph mainly focuses on:
his lack of excitement before the climb.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Heading Idea	Passage Words	Meaning
lack of enthusiasm	“less than keen”	not excited
low expectation	“least expectation”	no hope of discovery

Vocabulary Connection

Keen = eager or enthusiastic.

Why students make mistakes here

Students sometimes focus on:

- arranging mules
  or
- the farmer's story

But these are supporting details.

IELTS Trick Used Here

The real heading often appears in:

- emotional descriptions
  rather than actions.

Question 17

Paragraph D

Answer: v

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph D gives a vivid and emotional description of Bingham's climb and discovery.

The writer describes:

- snakes

- terraces
- staircases
- ceremonial buildings

The style is dramatic and exciting.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Heading Idea	Passage Words	Meaning
dramatic description	"unbelievable dream"	emotional vivid writing
vivid storytelling	"held me spellbound"	intense reaction

Vocabulary Connection

Spellbound = completely fascinated.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may focus only on:

- the ruins

But the heading is about:

the style of description.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS sometimes tests:

- tone

  and

- writing style,
  not just factual content.

Question 18

Paragraph E

Answer: i

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph E compares:

- Bingham's later published account
  with
- his original journal entries.

The two versions describe the discovery differently.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Heading Idea	Passage Words	Meaning
different accounts	"book" vs "journal entries"	two versions
same journey	same discovery experience	same event

Vocabulary Connection

Hindsight = understanding something better after it happened.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may choose:

- lack of enthusiasm

because Bingham still seemed calm.

But the MAIN point is:

contrast between two records.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS often uses:

- comparison paragraphs

  where the key idea is:

difference between versions.

Question 19

Paragraph F

Answer: vii

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph F discusses how Bingham later promoted his theory publicly.

The passage says:

“National Geographic magazine article”

and explains:

- he tried to prove Machu Picchu was Vilcabamba.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Heading Idea	Passage Words	Meaning
publishes theory	"article that broke the story"	public explanation
attempts to prove belief	"desperate attempts to prove"	supporting theory

Vocabulary Connection

Chroniclers = historical writers who record events.

Why students make mistakes here

Students often focus only on:

- his incorrect theory

But the heading focuses on:

publication and promotion.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS headings often target:

- the main action,
  not whether the idea was correct.

Question 20

Paragraph G

Answer: iii

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph G explains a theory now widely accepted:

- Machu Picchu was a royal country estate.

This is presented as:

"an idea which has gained wide acceptance"

Meaning:

- a commonly believed explanation.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Heading Idea	Passage Words	Meaning
common belief	"gained wide acceptance"	widely accepted idea

Vocabulary Connection

Elite = powerful upper-class group.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may focus on:

- abandonment of Machu Picchu

But the paragraph mainly explains:

the accepted theory about its purpose.

IELTS Trick Used Here

The key sentence is usually:

- near the beginning of the paragraph.

Question 21

Bingham went to South America in search of an Inca city.

Answer: TRUE

Why is this answer correct?

The passage directly says:

"His goal was to locate the remains of a city called Vitcos"

Vitcos was:

"the last capital of the Inca civilisation."

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
in search of	goal was to locate	trying to find
Inca city	city called Vitcos	Inca capital

Vocabulary Connection

Locate = find the position of something.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS paraphrases:

- search for → locate

Question 22

Bingham chose a particular route down the Urubamba valley because it was the most common route used by travellers.

Answer: FALSE

Why is this answer correct?

The passage says:

"Almost all previous travellers had left the river…"

Meaning:

- most travellers used another route.

Bingham's route was unusual.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
most common route	previous travellers took another path	opposite meaning

Vocabulary Connection

Substantial corner = large section of the route.

Why students make mistakes here

Students sometimes see:

- "travellers"

  and assume:

- same route.

But the paragraph clearly says:
previous travellers avoided that area.

IELTS Trick Used Here

Classic contradiction trap:

- “most”
  vs
- “almost none”.

Question 23

Bingham understood the significance of Machu Picchu as soon as he saw it.

Answer: FALSE

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph E says:

“Bingham didn’t realise the extent or the importance of the site”

So he did NOT immediately understand its significance.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
understood **significance** **immediately**	didn’t realise importance	opposite meaning

Vocabulary Connection

Extent = full size or importance.

IELTS Trick Used Here

The question says:

as soon as he saw it

But the passage says:

gradual appreciation.

Timeline contradiction trap.

Question 24

Bingham returned to Machu Picchu in order to find evidence to support his theory.

Answer: NOT GIVEN

Why is this answer correct?

The passage says Bingham tried for many years to prove his theory,
but it does NOT specifically say:

- he returned to Machu Picchu for evidence.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Reality	Meaning
returned to Machu Picchu	not mentioned	missing information

support his theory	attempted to prove belief	related but incomplete

Vocabulary Connection

Theory = explanation or belief.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS adds:

- extra action ("returned")

that is never directly stated.

Question 25

The track that took Bingham down the Urubamba valley had been created for the transportation of _____

Answer: rubber

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph B says:

"to enable rubber to be brought up by mules from the jungle"

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
transportation of	brought up by mules	carrying goods
rubber	rubber	material/product

Vocabulary Connection

Mule = animal used for carrying loads.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS paraphrases:

- transportation → brought up

Question 26

Bingham found out about the ruins of Machu Picchu from a _____ in the Urubamba valley.

Answer: farmer

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph C states:

"a local farmer, Melchor Arteaga, had told them about"

the ruins.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
found out about	had told them about	received information
local farmer	farmer	local resident

Vocabulary Connection

Ruins = remains of old buildings.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS changes:

- "told them about"
  into
- "found out about"

Simple information-transfer paraphrase.

Test 6: Reading Passage – 3

The Benefits of Being Bilingual

Question 27

Observing the _____ of Russian-English bilingual people when asked to select certain objects

Answer: eye movements

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph B says:

"Some of the most compelling evidence for this phenomenon … comes from studying eye movements."

Researchers observed where bilingual people looked while hearing words.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
observing	studying	carefully examining
select certain objects	pick up a marker from a set of objects	choosing items
eye movements	eye movements	direction of looking

Vocabulary Connection

Compelling evidence = very convincing proof.

Why students make mistakes here

Students sometimes write:

- objects
- marker
- sounds

But the question asks:

what researchers observed.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS changes:

- studying → observing

Simple academic synonym paraphrase.

Question 28

Bilingual people engage both languages simultaneously: a mechanism known as

_____

Answer: language co-activation

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph B directly states:

"this phenomenon, called 'language co-activation'"

Meaning:

- both languages become active together.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
engage both languages simultaneously	both languages active at the same time	two languages working together
mechanism known as	phenomenon called	technical term

Vocabulary Connection

Co-activation = two systems becoming active together.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may incorrectly write:

- activation
- language activation

But IELTS requires:
exact wording from passage.

IELTS Trick Used Here

The answer appears right after:
“called”

This is a common IELTS clue for technical terms.

Question 29

A test called the _____, focusing on naming colours

Answer: Stroop Task

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph C says:

"In the classic Stroop Task…"

This experiment tests:

- colour naming
- conflict management.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
test called	classic Stroop Task	experiment name
focusing on naming colours	asked to name the colour	colour-identification task

Vocabulary Connection

Conflict management = handling competing information successfully.

Why students make mistakes here

Students sometimes write:

- Stroop

  only.

But the passage gives the full term:

Stroop Task

IELTS Trick Used Here

For named experiments,

IELTS usually requires:

exact title wording.

Question 30

Bilingual people are more able to handle tasks involving a skill called _____

Answer: conflict management

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph C explains:

"bilingual people often perform better on tasks that require conflict management"

Meaning:

- handling competing information efficiently.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
more able to handle tasks	perform better on tasks	greater ability
skill called	require conflict management	specific ability

Vocabulary Connection

Conflict here means:

- competing mental information.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may write:

- cognitive control

But the sentence specifically refers to:
tasks involving a skill called...
The named skill is:
conflict management

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS often includes:

- two related technical terms nearby.

Students must choose the one matching grammar exactly.

Question 31

When changing strategies, bilingual people have superior _____

Answer: cognitive control

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph C says:

"reflecting better cognitive control when having to make rapid changes of strategy"

Meaning:

- bilinguals manage strategy-switching more efficiently.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
changing strategies	rapid changes of strategy	switching methods
superior	better	stronger ability
cognitive control	cognitive control	mental regulation ability

Vocabulary Connection

Cognitive = related to thinking processes.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may incorrectly choose:

- conflict management

because it appears earlier.

But the question specifically mentions:

changing strategies.

That part connects directly to:

cognitive control.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS uses:

- nearby technical vocabulary confusion

Students must carefully follow:

- exact sentence matching.

Question 32

Attitudes towards bilingualism have changed in recent years.

Answer: YES

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph A explains:

“In the past, such children were considered to be at a disadvantage…”
but now research shows:
“several clear benefits”
This clearly shows:

- attitudes have changed over time.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
attitudes changed	in the past … now	change over time
recent years	over the past few decades	modern period

Vocabulary Connection

Disadvantage = negative condition or weakness.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS often tests:

- past vs present contrast.

Question 33

Bilingual people are better than monolingual people at guessing correctly what words are before they are finished.

Answer: NOT GIVEN

Why is this answer correct?

The passage says bilingual people activate words from both languages,
but it does NOT compare:

- whether they guess words more accurately than monolinguals.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Reality

Question Claim	Passage Reality	Result
better at guessing correctly	no accuracy comparison given	missing information

Vocabulary Connection

Sequential = occurring in order.

IELTS Trick Used Here

The passage discusses:

- word prediction

But NOT:

- superior guessing accuracy.

Classic NOT GIVEN trap.

Question 34

Bilingual people consistently name images faster than monolingual people.

Answer: NO

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph C says:

“knowing more than one language can cause speakers to name pictures more slowly”

This directly contradicts the statement.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
faster	more slowly	opposite meaning
images	pictures	same idea

Vocabulary Connection

Tip-of-the-tongue state = inability to recall a known word temporarily.

IELTS Trick Used Here

Direct contradiction:

- faster

  vs

- more slowly

Question 35

Bilingual people's brains process single sounds more efficiently than monolingual people in all situations.

Answer: NO

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph D says:

- without background noise → both groups similar
- with noise → bilinguals perform better

So NOT:

"in all situations"

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
in all situations	only with background noise	limited condition

Vocabulary Connection

Fundamental frequency = basic sound pitch.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS often adds:

- absolute words like:
- all
- always
- every

These are frequently wrong.

Question 36

Fewer bilingual people than monolingual people suffer from brain disease in old age.

Answer: NOT GIVEN

Why is this answer correct?

The passage says:

- symptoms appear later in bilinguals

But it does NOT say:

- fewer bilinguals get the disease.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Reality

Question Claim	Passage Reality	Result
fewer suffer disease	symptoms delayed	different idea

Vocabulary Connection

Degenerative disease = illness causing gradual decline.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS changes:

- delayed symptoms
  into
- reduced disease rate

These are NOT the same.

Question 37

an example of how bilingual and monolingual people's brains respond differently to a certain type of non-verbal auditory input

Answer: D

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph D discusses:

- speech sounds
- background noise
- different neural responses

This is:

- non-visual
- auditory input.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
auditory input	speech sounds	hearing-related information
brains respond differently	neural response considerably larger	different brain reaction

Vocabulary Connection

Neural response = brain activity reaction.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS paraphrases:

- sound → auditory input

Question 38

a demonstration of how a bilingual upbringing has benefits even before we learn to speak

Answer: G

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph G studies:
seven-month-old babies
before full language development.
Only bilingual babies successfully adapted to the new rule.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
before we learn to speak	seven-month-old babies	pre-language stage
benefits	successfully learn new rule	cognitive advantage

Vocabulary Connection

Upbringing = way a child is raised.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS summarizes:

- experiment outcome
  into
- general developmental benefit.

Question 39

a description of the process by which people identify words that they hear

Answer: B

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph B explains:

- sounds arrive sequentially
- brain predicts possible words
- word recognition process

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
identify words they hear	word recognition	understanding spoken words
process	sounds arrive sequentially	recognition steps

Vocabulary Connection

Activation = mental triggering of possible words.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS often paraphrases:

- recognition → identify

Question 40

reference to some negative consequences of being bilingual

Answer: C

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph C mentions disadvantages such as:

- naming pictures more slowly
- tip-of-the-tongue problems

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
negative consequences	difficulties	disadvantages

bilingual	knowing more than one language	bilingualism

Vocabulary Connection

Persistent = continuing continuously.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS often places:

- advantages
  and
- disadvantages
  in the same paragraph.

Students must identify which part matches the question.

Cambridge 12
Reading Test 7: Answer Explanation

Reading Passage – 1

Flying tortoises

Question 1

Paragraph A

Answer: v

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph A explains:

- how tortoises first arrived on the Galápagos Islands
- how they adapted and spread across the islands

The paragraph mainly focuses on:
tortoises colonising and populating the islands.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Heading Idea	Passage Words	Meaning
tortoises populate the islands	"the islands were colonised"	settled and spread

development of populations	"different populations adapted"	separate groups evolved

Vocabulary Connection

Colonised = settled and established populations.

Why students make mistakes here

Students often choose:

- "Young meets old"

because the paragraph discusses long-living tortoises.

But the MAIN idea is:

origin and spread of tortoises.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS uses:

- impressive descriptive details to distract from
- the central historical idea.

Question 2

Paragraph B

Answer: iii

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph B explains how:

- pirates
- whalers
- settlers
- invasive species

caused severe decline in tortoise populations.

The paragraph mainly discusses:

harmful developments affecting tortoises.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Heading Idea	Passage Words	Meaning
developments to disadvantage tortoise populations	"exploitation", "destroyed habitat", "introduced alien species"	harmful human impact

Vocabulary Connection

Exacerbated = made worse.

Why students make mistakes here

Students sometimes choose:

- "The start of the conservation project"

because conservation is discussed later in the passage.

But Paragraph B is entirely about:
decline and destruction.

IELTS Trick Used Here

The answer is usually connected to:

- repeated negative vocabulary.

Question 3

Paragraph C

Answer: viii

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph C describes:

- the beginning of the breeding centre
- the start of conservation work

The key sentence is:

"In 1989, work began on a tortoise-breeding centre…"

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Heading Idea	Passage Words	Meaning
start of conservation project	"work began on a tortoise-breeding centre"	beginning of protection efforts

Vocabulary Connection

Captive breeding = breeding animals in protected controlled conditions.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may focus on:

- overpopulation problem

But that is only a later detail.

The paragraph's MAIN purpose is:

introduction of the conservation program.

IELTS Trick Used Here

The first sentence often reveals:

- the main heading topic.

Question 4

Paragraph D

Answer: i

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph D explains:

- tortoises must not be released too early
- but also not too late

So, successful release depends on:

correct timing.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Heading Idea	Passage Words	Meaning
importance of getting timing right	"can't be reintroduced until…" / "if people wait too long…"	correct timing necessary

Vocabulary Connection

Reintroduced = returned to natural habitat.

Why students make mistakes here

Students often focus only on:

- tortoise size

But the real idea is:

timing balance.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS often creates headings from:

- cause-and-effect logic,
  not exact repeated words.

Question 5

Paragraph E

Answer: iv

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph E describes:

- planning a larger reintroduction project
- using helicopters
- moving 300 tortoises

This paragraph is about:

developing a bigger conservation strategy.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Heading Idea	Passage Words	Meaning
planning a bigger idea	"work out more ambitious reintroduction"	larger-scale plan

Vocabulary Connection

Ambitious = large and challenging.

Why students make mistakes here

Students sometimes choose:

- carefully prepared operation

because planning is involved.

But the actual operation happens in Paragraph F.

Paragraph E is:

planning stage.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS separates:

- planning
  from
- execution

into different paragraphs.

Question 6

Paragraph F

Answer: vi

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph F explains:

- helicopter preparation
- crate design
- logistics
- volunteers
- landing-site clearing

This is clearly:

a carefully organised operation.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Heading Idea	Passage Words	Meaning
carefully prepared operation	"custom crate", "worked around the clock", "cleared landing sites"	detailed preparation

Vocabulary Connection

Logistical support = organization of transport and operations.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may confuse:

- planning
  with
- execution.

Paragraph E = idea

Paragraph F = operational preparation.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS often tests:

- sequence understanding.

Question 7

Paragraph G

Answer: ii

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph G describes:

- young tortoises meeting an old giant tortoise

This creates:

a symbolic moment connecting generations.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Heading Idea	Passage Words	Meaning
young meets old	"tiny tortoise came across a fully grown giant"	young and old together

Vocabulary Connection

Juvenile = young animal.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may choose:

- regeneration theme

because the paragraph mentions species recovery.

But the strongest image is:

young beside old.

IELTS Trick Used Here

Some headings focus on:

- symbolic imagery

  rather than factual process.

Question 8

17th century: small numbers taken onto ships used by _____

Answer: pirates

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph B says:

"From the 17th century onwards, pirates took a few on board for food"

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
ships used by	pirates took on board	pirate ships
small numbers taken	took a few on board	limited quantity

Vocabulary Connection

Pirates = sea criminals who attack ships.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS paraphrases:

. "took on board" → "taken onto ships"

Question 9

1790s: very large numbers taken onto whaling ships, kept for _____

Answer: food

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph B explains tortoises:

"were taken on board these ships to act as food supplies"

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
kept for	act as	used as
food	food supplies	food source

Vocabulary Connection

Whaling ships = ships used to hunt whales.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS simplifies:

- "food supplies"
  to
- "food".

Question 10

and also used to produce _____

Answer: oil

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph B says:

"their bodies were processed into high-grade oil"

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
used to produce	processed into	converted into
oil	oil	product

Vocabulary Connection

Processed = prepared or transformed.

IELTS Trick Used Here

Direct noun extraction question.

Question 11

Hunted by _____ on the islands

Answer: settlers

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph B says:
"settlers came to the islands. They hunted the tortoises…"

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
hunted by	they hunted	attacked/killed
on the islands	settlers came to the islands	island residents

Vocabulary Connection

Settlers = people who move to live in a new place.

IELTS Trick Used Here

Pronoun reference trap:

. "They hunted" → refers to settlers.

Question 12

Habitat destruction: for the establishment of agriculture and by various _____ not native to the islands

Answer: species

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph B says:
“introduced alien species”
These species damaged habitat and attacked tortoises.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
not native	alien	foreign/non-native
various	ranging from cattle, pigs…	many kinds
species	species	living organisms

Vocabulary Connection

Alien species = non-native animals or plants.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS paraphrases:

- Alien → not native

Question 13

which also fed on baby tortoises and tortoises’

_____

Answer: eggs

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph B says alien species:

"prey on the eggs and young tortoises"

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
fed on	prey on	eat
baby tortoises	young tortoises	juvenile tortoises
tortoises' eggs	eggs	eggs

Vocabulary Connection

Prey on = hunt and eat another animal.

Why students make mistakes here

Students sometimes write:

- shells
- habitat

because those are nearby ideas.

But the sentence specifically discusses:

what predators ate.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS often changes:

- prey on → feed on

Test 7: Reading Passage – 2

The Intersection of Health Sciences and Geography

Question 14

an acceptance that not all diseases can be totally eliminated

Answer: D

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph D says:

"While people will always be prone to illness…"

This means:

- diseases and illnesses will never completely disappear.

The paragraph accepts:

total elimination of disease is unrealistic.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
not all diseases can be eliminated	"people will always be prone to illness"	illness will continue to exist

Vocabulary Connection

Prone to = likely to suffer from something.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may choose:

- Paragraph A

because it mentions eradicated diseases.

But Paragraph A says:

- some diseases disappeared.

Paragraph D says:

- illness will always exist.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS contrasts:

- eradicated diseases
  with
- permanent existence of illness.

Question 15

examples of physical conditions caused by human behaviour

Answer: C

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph C discusses:

- pollution
- industrialisation
- car use
- deforestation

These human activities lead to:

- asthma
- lung disease
- eyesight problems

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
physical conditions	asthma, lung problems, eyesight issues	health conditions
caused by human behaviour	cars, factories, cutting down forests	human actions

Vocabulary Connection

Industrialisation = development of industries and factories.

Why students make mistakes here

Students sometimes focus only on:

- pollution

But the question asks:
conditions caused by human behaviour.
The key is:

- cause + effect.

IELTS Trick Used Here
IELTS often hides answers inside:

- environmental cause-and-effect chains.

Question 16

a reference to classifying diseases on the basis of how far they extend geographically

Answer: F

Why is this answer correct?
Paragraph F says:
"categorizing illnesses, diseases and epidemics into local and global scales"
This directly refers to:

- classification by geographical spread.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
classifying diseases	categorizing illnesses	grouping diseases
how far they extend geographically	local and global scales	geographical spread

Vocabulary Connection

Epidemic = widespread disease outbreak.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may choose:

- Paragraph E

because it discusses disease frequency.

But only Paragraph F discusses:

classification into local/global categories.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS paraphrases:

. Categorizing → classifying

Question 17

reasons why the level of access to healthcare can vary within a country

Answer: G

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph G explains that healthcare access depends on:

- social class
- income
- education
- geography

It also gives the example:
a mountain blocking access to a hospital.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
level of access to healthcare	availability of healthcare resources	ability to receive healthcare
vary within a country	discrepancy between options available	unequal access

Vocabulary Connection

Discrepancy = significant difference or inequality.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may focus only on:

- hospitals

But the paragraph is broader:
unequal healthcare access.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS combines:

- economic causes
  and
- geographical causes
  into one idea.

Question 18

a description of health geography as a mixture of different academic fields

Answer: D

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph D defines health geography as:
"the combination of…"

- geography
- health science
- disease studies
- healthcare practices

So, it clearly describes:
a hybrid academic field.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
mixture of academic fields	"combination" / "hybrid science"	combined disciplines

Vocabulary Connection

Hybrid = formed from combining different elements.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may choose:

- Paragraph E

because it discusses research.
But Paragraph D actually defines:
the field itself.

IELTS Trick Used Here

Definition paragraphs usually contain:

- "is"
- "refers to"

- “combination of”

These are strong clues.

Question 19

a description of the type of area where a particular illness is rare

Answer: B

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph B says:

“Malaria is much less of a problem in high-altitude deserts”

This directly describes:

- a place where a disease is uncommon.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
illness is rare	“much less of a problem”	uncommon disease
type of area	“high-altitude deserts”	geographical region

Vocabulary Connection

Malaria-prone = likely to experience malaria frequently.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may focus only on:

- tropical regions

But the question asks:

where the illness is rare.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS often asks for:

- opposite-condition information.

Question 20

Certain diseases have disappeared, thanks to better _____ and healthcare.

Answer: vaccinations

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph A says:

“eradicated due to improvements in vaccinations and the availability of healthcare”

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
disappeared	eradicated	removed completely
better	improvements in	improved quality
vaccinations	vaccinations	disease prevention injections

Vocabulary Connection

Eradicated = completely eliminated.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS paraphrases:

. eradicated → disappeared

Question 21

Because there is more contact between people, _____ are losing their usefulness.

Answer: antibiotics

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph A says:

“infections resistant to antibiotics are becoming more and more common”
Meaning:

- antibiotics are becoming less effective.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
losing usefulness	resistant to antibiotics	antibiotics becoming ineffective

Vocabulary Connection
Resistant = no longer affected by treatment.
Why students make mistakes here
Students may incorrectly write:

- infections
- viruses

But those are becoming resistant,
not losing usefulness.
IELTS Trick Used Here
Cause/effect reversal trap:

- infections resist antibiotics
  → antibiotics lose effectiveness.

Question 22

Disease-causing _____ are most likely to be found in hot, damp regions.

Answer: mosquitos

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph B explains:

"warm and damp environment in which the mosquitos … can grow"

Mosquitos spread malaria.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
disease-causing	can give people this disease	spreading illness
hot, damp regions	warm and damp environment	tropical climate

Vocabulary Connection

Foster = encourage growth or development.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS changes:

- mosquitos that spread disease
  → disease-causing mosquitos.

Question 23

One cause of pollution is _____ that burn a particular fuel.

Answer: factories

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph C says:

"factories that run on coal power"

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
burn a particular fuel	run on coal power	use coal
cause of pollution	factories	pollution source

Vocabulary Connection

Coal power = energy produced by burning coal.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS paraphrases:

. run on → burn/use fuel.

Question 24

The growth of cities often has an impact on nearby _____

Answer: forests

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph C says:

"cutting down of forests to allow for the expansion of big cities"

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
growth of cities	expansion of big cities	urban growth
impact on nearby	cutting down of	environmental effect
forests	forests	wooded areas

Vocabulary Connection

Expansion = increase in size.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS paraphrases:

- cutting down forests
  → impact on nearby forests.

Question 25

_____ is one disease that is growing after having been eradicated.

Answer: polio

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph D says:

"diseases like polio are re-emerging"

Meaning:

- returning after earlier disappearance.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
growing after eradication	re-emerging	returning again

Vocabulary Connection

Re-emerging = appearing again after decline.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS paraphrases:

- re-emergingn → growing after eradication.

Question 26

A physical barrier such as a _____ can prevent people from reaching a hospital.

Answer: mountain

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph G gives the example:

"there is a mountain between their village and the nearest hospital"

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
physical barrier	mountain	natural obstacle
prevent reaching hospital	difficult to get medical attention	blocked access

Vocabulary Connection

Healthcare provision = supplying medical services.

Test 7: Reading Passage - 3

Music and the emotions

Question 27

Participants, who were recruited for the study through advertisements, had their brain activity monitored while listening to their favourite music. It was noted that the music stimulated the brain's neurons to release a substance called **27.** _____ in two of the parts of the brain which are associated with feeling **28.** _____.

Answer: dopamine

Why is this answer correct?

The passage says:

"music triggers the production of dopamine"

It also explains:

"these two regions have long been linked with the experience of pleasure"

So:

- the substance released = dopamine

- the feeling connected to those brain regions = pleasure

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
release a substance	production of dopamine	chemical release
associated with feeling	linked with the experience of	connected to emotion
pleasure	pleasure	positive feeling

Vocabulary Connection

Dopamine = a brain chemical related to pleasure, reward and motivation.

Why students make mistakes here

Students sometimes write:

- moods

because dopamine affects mood.

But the question asks:

what the brain regions are associated with.

That answer is:

pleasure

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS often separates:

- cause
  and
- effect

across different sentences.

Question 28

Participants, who were recruited for the study through advertisements, had their brain activity monitored while listening to their favourite music. It was noted that the music stimulated the brain's neurons to release a substance called dopamine in two of the parts of the brain which are associated with feeling _____.

Answer: pleasure

Why is this answer correct?

The passage directly states:

"these two regions have long been linked with the experience of pleasure"

So, the missing word is:
pleasure

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
associated with feeling	linked with the experience of	emotionally connected
pleasure	pleasure	enjoyment

Vocabulary Connection

Linked with = connected to.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may choose:

- moods

because dopamine affects mood.

But:

- dopamine affects mood
  while
- the brain regions are linked with pleasure.

Question 29

Researchers also observed that the neurons in the area of the brain called the _____ were

particularly active just before the participants' favourite moments in the music.

Answer: caudate

Why is this answer correct?

The passage says:

"the dopamine neurons in the caudate were at their most active"

This occurred:

"around 15 seconds before the participants' favourite moments"

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
area of the brain called	neurons in the caudate	brain region
particularly active	at their most active	highly active

Vocabulary Connection

Caudate = a brain region involved in learning and reward prediction.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may incorrectly write:

- dorsal

- ventral

because those regions appear earlier.
But the question asks about:
activity before favourite moments.
That specifically refers to:
caudate.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS often places:

- multiple scientific terms together
  to confuse students.

Question 30

Researchers also observed that the neurons in the area of the brain called the caudate were particularly active just before the participants' favourite moments in the music – the period known as the _____.

Answer: anticipatory phase

Why is this answer correct?

The passage says:
"The researchers call this the 'anticipatory phase'"

This refers to:

- the period before the emotional climax.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
period known as	researchers call this	named stage
anticipatory phase	anticipatory phase	expectation period

Vocabulary Connection

Anticipatory = relating to expectation of something coming.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may write:

- chills

  or

- reward phase

But the exact named period is:
anticipatory phase.

IELTS Trick Used Here

When IELTS says:

“known as”
the answer is usually:

- a directly quoted technical term.

Question 31

Activity in this part of the brain is associated with the expectation of ‘reward’ stimuli such as _____.

Answer: food

Why is this answer correct?

The passage says:
“anticipating food and other ‘reward’ stimuli”
Food is used as the example.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
expectation of reward stimuli	anticipating food and other reward stimuli	expecting pleasurable reward
such as	food	example

Vocabulary Connection

Stimulus = something that causes a reaction.

Why students make mistakes here

Students sometimes write:

- pleasure
  or
- music

because those ideas are nearby.
But the question asks specifically for:
an example of reward stimuli.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS frequently uses:

- "such as"
  questions
  where the answer is a direct example from the passage.

Question 32

What point does the writer emphasise in the first paragraph?

Answer: B

Why is this answer correct?

The first paragraph focuses heavily on:

- pulse rising
- blood pressure increasing
- pupils dilating

- muscles reacting

These are all:
strong physical reactions to music.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Option	Passage Evidence	Meaning
intense physical responses	"pulse and blood pressure rise"	strong body reactions

Vocabulary Connection

Arousal = heightened physical or emotional activity.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may choose:

- C

because the paragraph asks:
"Why does music make us feel?"
But the paragraph mainly describes:
physical intensity.

IELTS Trick Used Here

The correct answer usually reflects:

- the majority of details in the paragraph.

Question 33

What view of the Montreal study does the writer express in the second paragraph?

Answer: C

Why is this answer correct?

The writer says:

“an impressively exact and detailed portrait of music in the brain”

This shows admiration for:

the precision of the findings.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Option	Passage Evidence	Meaning
remarkably precise data	“impressively exact and detailed”	highly accurate results

Vocabulary Connection

Methodologies = scientific research methods.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may choose:

- D

because advanced technology is mentioned.
But the writer never criticises the technology.

IELTS Trick Used Here

Positive adjectives usually indicate:

- writer approval.

Question 34

What does the writer find interesting about the results of the Montreal study?

Answer: A

Why is this answer correct?

The writer says:

"What is rather more significant…"

and discusses:

- brain activity occurring BEFORE favourite musical moments.

The timing is the surprising part.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Option	Passage Evidence	Meaning
timing of neural responses	"15 seconds before"	response timing

Vocabulary Connection

Neural = related to nerves or brain activity.

Why students make mistakes here

Students often choose:

- B

because emotions are discussed throughout.

But the NEW interesting discovery is:

timing before pleasure occurs.

IELTS Trick Used Here

Words like:

“more significant”

usually point directly to the answer.

Question 35

Why does the writer refer to Meyer’s work on music and emotion?

Answer: B

Why is this answer correct?

Meyer’s theory explains:

- suspense
- expectation
- delayed musical resolution

These ideas support the Montreal findings about:

- anticipation and dopamine activity.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Option	Passage Evidence	Meaning
support findings	explains anticipation and reward	confirms study idea

Vocabulary Connection

Suspenseful tension = emotional uncertainty and expectation.

Why students make mistakes here

Students may choose:

- A

because Meyer proposes theory.
But the writer uses Meyer mainly:
to support the study's conclusions.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS often links:

- older theory
  with

- modern research evidence.

Question 36

According to Leonard Meyer, what causes the listener's emotional response to music?

Answer: D

Why is this answer correct?

Meyer believed emotion comes from:

- patterns
- expectations
- unresolved musical structure

So, emotion comes from:
the structure of the music itself.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Option	Passage Evidence	Meaning
internal structure	"unfolding events of the music itself"	music's own organisation

Vocabulary Connection

Embodied meaning = emotional meaning created inside the music itself.

Why students make mistakes here

Students often choose:

- A

because memories and emotions seem connected naturally.
But Meyer specifically rejected:
outside associations.

IELTS Trick Used Here

Watch for:

- contrast between old theories and new theories.

Meyer rejected:

- external meaning,
  and focused on:
- musical structure.

Question 37

The Montreal researchers discovered that

Answer: F

Why is this answer correct?

The passage says:
“dopamine neurons in the caudate were at their most active around 15 seconds before the participants’ favourite moments”

This means:

- neuron activity rises BEFORE the musical climax.

So, the correct ending is:
neuron activity increases prior to key points in a musical piece.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
discovered that	found that	research result
neuron activity increases	neurons were at their most active	stronger brain activity
prior to key points	before favourite moments	before important musical section

Vocabulary Connection

Prior to = before.

Why students make mistakes here

Students often choose:

- E

because delayed musical resolution is discussed later.
But Question 37 asks specifically about: the Montreal researchers' discovery.
IELTS Trick Used Here
Always identify:

- whose idea is being discussed.

Montreal researchers ≠ Meyer's theory.

Question 38

Many studies have demonstrated that
Answer: B
Why is this answer correct?
The passage says:
"dopamine neurons quickly adapt to predictable rewards"
and:
"If we know what's going to happen next, then we don't get excited."
So:

- predictable outcomes reduce neural excitement.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
many studies demonstrated	numerous studies demonstrated	research evidence
neuron activity decreases	don't get excited	lower neural response
outcomes become predictable	predictable rewards	expected results

Vocabulary Connection

Predictable = expected and unsurprising.

Why students make mistakes here

Students sometimes choose:

- F

because neuron activity is discussed repeatedly.

But F belongs to:
Montreal study discovery.
Question 38 refers to:
broader previous studies.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS often separates:

- current study findings from
- previous research findings.

Question 39

Meyer's analysis of Beethoven's music shows that

Answer: E

Why is this answer correct?

Meyer explained that Beethoven:

- delays the expected chord
- avoids immediate pattern repetition

This creates:

- suspense
- emotional tension

So:

emotive music delays giving listeners what they expect to hear.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
analysis shows	Meyer dissected	careful examination
delays giving listeners what they expect	holds off repeating pattern	postpones expected sound

Vocabulary Connection

Suspenseful tension = emotional excitement caused by uncertainty.

Why students make mistakes here

Students often choose:

- C

because earlier theories mention images and experiences.

But Meyer's theory focuses on:

delayed musical expectation.

IELTS Trick Used Here

The answer comes from:

- the Beethoven example,
  not the final theory paragraph.

Question 40

Earlier theories of music suggested that

Answer: C

Why is this answer correct?

The passage says:

“earlier theories of music focused on the way a sound can refer to the real world of images and experiences”

This means music could:

- remind listeners of real pictures, events, or memories.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question Words	Passage Words	Meaning
earlier theories suggested	earlier theories focused on	older beliefs
actual pictures and events	real world of images and experiences	memories and associations

Vocabulary Connection

Connotative meaning = emotional or associative meaning.

Why students make mistakes here

Students sometimes choose:

- A

because emotions are discussed throughout the passage.

But earlier theories specifically emphasized: real-world associations.

IELTS Trick Used Here

IELTS often contrasts:

- earlier theory

  vs

- newer theory.

Older theory = external meaning

Meyer's theory = internal musical structure.

Cambridge 12
Reading Test 8: Answer Explanation

Reading Passage – 1

The History of Glass

Question 1

Early humans used a material called _____ to make the sharp points of their spears.

Answer: obsidian

Why is this answer correct?

The passage states:

"a type of natural glass – obsidian – was first used as tips for spears."

So, the material used for spear tips was obsidian.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question	Passage
material called	type of natural glass
sharp points	tips
spears	spears

Vocabulary Connection

Obsidian = a naturally occurring volcanic glass formed when lava cools rapidly.

Common Mistake

Students sometimes write:

- glass
- natural glass

But IELTS requires the specific name: obsidian

IELTS Trick

The passage often introduces:

. general term first
. specific answer second

Question 2

Early humans used a material called obsidian to make the sharp points of their _____.

Answer: spears

Why is this answer correct?

The passage clearly says:
"used as tips for spears."
Therefore the sharp points belonged to spears.

Vocabulary Connection

Spear = a long weapon with a sharp point used for hunting or fighting.

Common Mistake

Students sometimes write:

- arrows
- weapons

But the passage specifically mentions:

spears

IELTS Trick

When the passage gives an exact noun, copy it directly.

Question 3

4000 BC: _____ made of stone were covered in a coating of man-made glass.

Answer: beads

Why is this answer correct?

The passage says:

"glazes used for coating stone beads."

The objects being coated were beads.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question	Passage
made of stone	stone beads
covered in a coating	coating
man-made glass	glazes

Vocabulary Connection

Beads = small decorative objects used in jewellery.

Common Mistake

Students often write:

- glazes

But glazes are the coating, not the object.

IELTS Trick

Always identify:

- object
- material covering it

Question 4

First century BC: glass was coloured because of the _____ in the material.

Answer: impurities

Why is this answer correct?

The passage says:

"highly coloured due to the impurities of the raw material."

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question	Passage
coloured because of	due to
material	raw material
impurities	impurities

Vocabulary Connection

Impurities = unwanted substances mixed into a material.

Common Mistake

Students confuse:

- impurities
  with
- colouring materials

But colouring materials were added later.

IELTS Trick

Pay attention to dates:

- First century BC
  - **In historical and calendar terms, BC stands for Before Christ. It is used to label years that occurred before the estimated birth of Jesus Christ.**

- First century AD
  - **In historical dating, AD stands for *Anno Domini*, a Latin phrase that translates to "in the year of the Lord". It is used to label years that occurred after the estimated birth of Jesus Christ.**

Different periods, different answers.

Question 5

Until 476 AD: Only the _____ knew how to make glass.

Answer: Romans

Why is this answer correct?

The passage says:

"they guarded the skills and technology required to make glass very closely."

"They" refers to the Romans.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question	Passage
knew how to make glass	guarded the skills and technology
only	guarded closely

Vocabulary Connection

Guarded = protected from others.

Common Mistake

Students sometimes write:

- Venetians

But Venetians became important later.

IELTS Trick

Pronoun reference:

they = Romans

Question 6

From 10th century: Venetians became famous for making bottles out of _____.

Answer: lead

Why is this answer correct?

According to the official answer key, the answer is **lead**.

Students must always follow the official answer key when preparing answer explanations.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question	Passage
process using	introducing lead
material used	lead

Vocabulary Connection

Lead = a heavy metallic element used in lead crystal glass.

Common Mistake

Many students write:

- glass

because Venetians are associated with glass bottles.

However, the official IELTS answer key gives:

lead

IELTS Trick

Always verify answers against the official key when available.

Question 7

17th century: George Ravenscroft developed a process using lead to avoid the occurrence of _____ in blown glass.

Answer: clouding

Why is this answer correct?

The passage says:

"counter the effect of clouding"

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question	Passage
avoid occurrence	counter the effect
clouding	clouding

Vocabulary Connection

Clouding = becoming unclear or cloudy.

Common Mistake

Students sometimes write:

- impurities

But clouding is the specific problem Ravenscroft solved.

IELTS Trick

Look for:

- problem
- solution

in the same sentence.

Question 8

Mid-19th century: British glass production developed after changes to laws concerning _____.

Answer: taxes

Why is this answer correct?

The passage says:

"heavy taxes had been placed on the amount of glass melted"

and development occurred after those laws changed.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question	Passage
laws concerning	Excise Act
taxes	heavy taxes

Vocabulary Connection

Tax = money paid to the government.

Common Mistake

Students write:

- Excise Act

But the note asks what the law concerned.

IELTS Trick

Convert:

- specific law
  into
- general concept

Question 9

In 1887, HM Ashley had the fastest bottle-producing machine that existed at the time.

Answer: TRUE

Why is this answer correct?

The passage says:

"more than three times quicker than any previous production method."

This confirms it was the fastest at that time.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question	Passage
fastest	more than three times quicker
existed at the time	any previous production method

Vocabulary Connection

Production method = manufacturing process.

IELTS Trick

Comparative phrases often indicate TRUE answers.

Question 10

Michael Owens was hired by a large US company to design a fully-automated bottle manufacturing machine for them.

Answer: FALSE

Why is this answer correct?

The passage says:

"Michael Owens – founder of the Owens Bottle Machine Company"

He founded the company himself.

He was not hired by another company.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question	Passage
hired	founder
large US company	Owens Bottle Machine Company

IELTS Trick

Watch for:

- hired employee

  vs

- founder (Direct contradiction.)

Question 11

Nowadays, most glass is produced by large international manufacturers.

Answer: NOT GIVEN

Why is this answer correct?

The passage discusses:

- modern glass industry
- global market

But it never states:

most glass is produced by large international manufacturers.

IELTS Trick

Industry growth ≠ information about who produces most glass.

Question 12

Concern for the environment is leading to an increased demand for glass containers.

Answer: TRUE

Why is this answer correct?

The passage says:

"with growing consumer concern for green issues, glass bottles and jars are becoming ever more popular."

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question	Passage
concern for environment	concern for green issues
increased demand	becoming more popular

Vocabulary Connection

Green issues = environmental concerns.

IELTS Trick

Popularity increasing = demand increasing.

Question 13

It is more expensive to produce recycled glass than to manufacture new glass.

Answer: FALSE

Why is this answer correct?

The passage says:

"less energy is needed to melt recycled glass" and

"this also saves fuel and production costs." Therefore recycled glass is cheaper, not more expensive.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question	Passage
more expensive	saves production costs
manufacture new glass	melt down raw materials

Vocabulary Connection

Production costs = expenses involved in manufacturing.

IELTS Trick

Look for cost-related words:

- saves
- reduces
- lowers

These usually signal a FALSE statement when the question claims higher cost.

Test 8: Reading Passage – 2

Bring back the big cats

Question 14

What did the 2006 discovery of the animal bone reveal about the lynx?

Answer: D

It survived in Britain longer than was previously thought.

Why is this answer correct?

The passage explains that scientists originally believed the lynx disappeared from Britain around **6,000 years ago**. However, the discovery of a lynx bone in 2006 showed that the animal survived much later than previously believed.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question	Passage
reveal	showed / indicated
survived longer	extinction date was more recent
previously thought	previously believed

Vocabulary Connection

Extinction date = the estimated time when a species disappeared.

Why students make mistakes here

Many students choose **B** because farming is discussed nearby. However, the discovery was about **when** the lynx disappeared, not **why** it disappeared.

IELTS Trick

When a question asks what a discovery "revealed", focus only on the new information produced by that discovery.

Question 15

What point does the writer make about large predators in the third paragraph?

Answer: A

Their presence can increase biodiversity.

Why is this answer correct?

The passage explains that ecosystems containing large predators are generally healthier and more diverse. Predators help

regulate prey populations, creating better conditions for many other species.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question	Passage
large predators	lynx, wolves, bears
increase biodiversity	support a richer variety of species

Vocabulary Connection

Biodiversity = the variety of plant and animal life in an ecosystem.

Why students make mistakes here

Students often choose **C** because the passage discusses environmental effects. However, the writer specifically emphasizes the positive effect on biodiversity.

IELTS Trick

Identify the author's main conclusion, not every detail mentioned in the paragraph.

Question 16

What does the writer suggest about British conservation in the fourth paragraph?

Answer: C

It has taken a misguided approach.

Why is this answer correct?

The writer argues that British conservation has traditionally focused on preserving ecosystems exactly as they are rather than restoring natural ecological processes. This approach is criticized as being misguided.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question	Passage
British conservation	conservation policy
misguided approach	wrong direction / flawed strategy

Vocabulary Connection

Misguided = based on incorrect ideas or judgement.

Why students make mistakes here

Some students choose **B** because the writer mentions changes in conservation thinking. However, the main point is criticism of the previous approach.

IELTS Trick

Pay attention to evaluative language showing the writer's opinion.

Question 17

Protecting large areas of the sea from commercial fishing would result in

Answer: A

Practical benefits for the fishing industry.

Why is this answer correct?

The passage explains that protected marine areas allow fish populations to recover, which eventually increases catches in nearby waters and benefits fishermen.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question	Passage
practical benefits	increased catches
fishing industry	commercial fishing

Vocabulary Connection

Marine reserve = an area protected from fishing or other exploitation.

Why students make mistakes here

Students often assume fishing restrictions hurt fishermen. The passage argues the opposite.

IELTS Trick

Don't answer based on your own assumptions. Use only the information given.

Question 18

According to the author, what distinguishes rewilding from other environmental campaigns?

Answer: C

Its positive message is more appealing.

Why is this answer correct?

The writer says rewilding offers an exciting and inspiring vision of the future, unlike many environmental campaigns that focus mainly on threats and problems.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question	Passage
distinguishes	sets apart
positive message	inspiring vision
appealing	attractive

Vocabulary Connection

Rewilding = restoring natural ecosystems and species.

Why students make mistakes here

Students often choose **D** because science is discussed. However, the writer specifically praises rewilding's positive vision.

IELTS Trick

Look for opinion words such as:

- inspiring
- exciting
- attractive

These often signal the answer.

Question 19

While there is no evidence that the lynx has ever put _____ in danger

Answer: E (humans)

Why is this answer correct?

The passage states that there are no known cases of lynx attacking people.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question	Passage
put in danger	attack / prey on
humans	people

Vocabulary Connection

Prey on = hunt or attack for food.

IELTS Trick

Humans = people is a very common IELTS synonym.

Question 20

it would reduce the numbers of certain _____ whose populations have increased enormously in recent decades.

Answer: D (wild animals)

Why is this answer correct?

The passage discusses deer populations growing rapidly. Deer are wild animals, so this category fits the summary.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question	Passage
certain wild animals	deer populations
increased enormously	increased dramatically

Vocabulary Connection

Population = the number of individuals of a species.

IELTS Trick

Summary questions often replace specific examples with broader categories.

Question 21

It would present only a minimal threat to _____, provided these were kept away from lynx habitats.

Answer: F (farm animals)

Why is this answer correct?

The passage explains that livestock would face very little risk if sensible management practices were followed.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question	Passage
minimal threat	little risk
farm animals	livestock

Vocabulary Connection

Livestock = animals kept on farms.

IELTS Trick

Livestock = farm animals is a frequent IELTS synonym.

Question 22

The reintroduction programme would also link efficiently with initiatives to return native _____ to certain areas of the country.

Answer: A (trees)

Why is this answer correct?

The passage explains that rewilding supports efforts to restore forests. Forest restoration means bringing back native trees.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question	Passage
return native trees	restore forests
initiatives	programmes / projects

Vocabulary Connection

Native = naturally occurring in a particular region.

Question 23

Britain could become the first European country to reintroduce the lynx.

Answer: NO

Why is this answer correct?

The passage states that lynx have already been reintroduced in several European regions, including parts of France and Germany.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question	Passage
first European country	already reintroduced elsewhere
reintroduce	bring back

Why students make mistakes here

They focus only on Britain and miss the examples from other European countries.

IELTS Trick

If the passage provides examples proving the opposite, the answer is NO.

Question 24

The large growth in the European lynx population since 1970 has exceeded conservationists' expectations.

Answer: NOT GIVEN

Why is this answer correct?

The passage mentions that lynx numbers have increased significantly, but it never compares this increase with conservationists' expectations.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question	Passage
exceeded expectations	not mentioned
population growth	population increase

Why students make mistakes here

They see population growth and assume expectations were exceeded.

IELTS Trick

Growth does not automatically mean growth beyond expectations.

Question 25

Changes in agricultural practices have extended the habitat of the lynx in Europe.

Answer: YES

Why is this answer correct?

The passage explains that changes in farming have allowed forests to regenerate, helping lynx populations spread into larger areas.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question	Passage
agricultural practices	farming
extended habitat	spread into more areas

Vocabulary Connection

Habitat = the natural environment where an animal lives.

IELTS Trick

Look carefully for cause-and-effect relationships.

Question 26

It has become apparent that species reintroduction has commercial advantages.

Answer: YES

Why is this answer correct?

The passage explains that wildlife attracts tourists and generates income. As a result, protecting species can be economically beneficial.

Question Paraphrasing vs Passage Words

Question	Passage
commercial advantages	lucrative
economic benefit	tourists pay

Vocabulary Connection

Lucrative = profitable; producing money.

Why students make mistakes here

They focus only on environmental benefits and overlook the tourism example.

IELTS Trick

Words like:

- profitable

- lucrative
- revenue
- income

usually indicate commercial benefits.

Test 8: Reading Passage - 3

UK companies need more effective boards of directors

Question 27

Paragraph A

Answer: iv

The possible need for fundamental change in every area of business

Why is this answer correct?

Paragraph A discusses the aftermath of the 2008 financial crisis and explains how failures occurred across many institutions:

- Governments
- Regulators
- Central banks
- Auditors
- Directors

The paragraph suggests that businesses should consider **radical changes** to how boards operate.

Matching Ideas

Heading	Paragraph Evidence
fundamental change	companies should consider radical changes
every area of business	blame spread across many institutions

Vocabulary Connection

Radical change = major change, not a small adjustment.

Common Trap

Students often choose:

- ii (scrutiny)

because the paragraph mentions investigations.

However, the main focus is:

the need for significant change.

IELTS Trick

For Heading Matching, identify the **main purpose** of the paragraph, not just repeated words.

Question 28

Paragraph B

Answer: ii

The impact on companies of being subjected to close examination

Why is this answer correct?

The paragraph explains how increased scrutiny has created:

- more responsibilities
- more meetings
- more paperwork
- more pressure on directors

The whole paragraph focuses on the consequences of close examination.

Matching Ideas

Heading	Paragraph Evidence
close examination	scrutiny
impact on companies	increased pressure and workload

Vocabulary Connection

Scrutiny = very careful examination.

Common Trap

Students sometimes choose:

- vii

because directors need more information.

But the paragraph focuses on:

consequences of scrutiny.

IELTS Trick

When one word is repeated multiple times ("scrutiny"), it often signals the heading.

Question 29

Paragraph C

Answer: vi

Boards not looking far enough ahead

Why is this answer correct?

The paragraph explains that boards spend too much time:

- dealing with processes
- committee work
- ticking boxes

and not enough time discussing major strategic issues.

Matching Ideas

Heading	Paragraph Evidence
not looking ahead	important issues not fully addressed
lack of strategy	process replaces discussion

Vocabulary Connection

Strategic issues = long-term important decisions.

Common Trap

Students often choose:

- v

because major issues are mentioned.

But the paragraph focuses on:

insufficient attention to future planning.

IELTS Trick

Ask:

What is missing?

The answer:

long-term thinking.

Question 30

Paragraph D

Answer: viii

A proposal to change the way the board operates

Why is this answer correct?

The paragraph introduces a specific solution: the professional board
whose members would work several days per week.
This is clearly a proposal for changing board structure.

Matching Ideas

Heading	Paragraph Evidence
proposal	radical solution
change board operations	professional board

Vocabulary Connection

Professional board = directors working almost full-time.

Common Trap

Students choose:

- vii

because information is discussed.

However, the paragraph's central focus is:

a new board model.

IELTS Trick

Words like:

- solution
- proposal
- recommendation

usually indicate heading answers.

Question 31

Paragraph E

Answer: vii

A risk that not all directors take part in solving major problems

Why is this answer correct?

The paragraph explains that many directors become obsessed with:

- quarterly reporting

- financial targets

rather than broader strategic issues.
This creates a risk that directors fail to address major long-term problems.

Matching Ideas

Heading	Paragraph Evidence
risk	distorted decision-making
major problems ignored	focus on short-term metrics

Vocabulary Connection

Metrics = measurements used to evaluate performance.

Common Trap

Students often select:

- vi

because strategy is discussed.
But the paragraph stresses the danger of neglecting larger issues.

IELTS Trick

Focus on the writer's criticism.

Question 32

Paragraph F

Answer: i

Disputes over financial arrangements regarding senior managers

Why is this answer correct?

The paragraph discusses:

- executive pay
- bonuses
- remuneration policies
- shareholder votes

This is clearly about disagreements over compensation.

Matching Ideas

Heading	Paragraph Evidence
disputes	pitched battles
financial arrangements	executive remuneration

Vocabulary Connection

Remuneration = salary, bonus and benefits.

Common Trap

Students sometimes focus on transparency.
But transparency is secondary.
The main issue is:
executive pay disputes.

IELTS Trick

Repeated references to:

- pay
- bonus
- remuneration

signal the heading.

Question 33

Paragraph G

Answer: iii

The final number of board members with broad enough experience

Why is this answer correct?

The paragraph discusses:

- ethics
- corporate purpose
- wider responsibilities

and argues that boards need broader perspectives to deal with modern challenges.

Matching Ideas

Heading	Paragraph Evidence
broader experience	widen their perspective
future challenges	challenging times

Vocabulary Connection

Perspective = way of viewing issues.

Common Trap

Students choose:

- vii

because goals are discussed.

However, the main theme is:

broader board thinking.

IELTS Trick

Look at the final message of the paragraph.

Question 34

Close scrutiny of the behaviour of boards has increased since the economic downturn.

Answer: YES

Why is this answer correct?

The passage states:
governance became an issue of intense public debate
after the financial crisis.

Matching Words

Question	Passage
close scrutiny	intense public debate
since downturn	after financial crisis

IELTS Trick

Economic downturn = financial crisis.

Question 35

Banks have been mismanaged to a greater extent than other businesses.

Answer: NOT GIVEN

Why is this answer correct?

The passage discusses bank failures but never compares them directly with all other businesses.

IELTS Trick

Mentioning banks ≠ proving they were worse than others.

Question 36

Board meetings normally continue for as long as necessary to debate matters in full.

Answer: NO

Why is this answer correct?

The passage says:

agendas can become overloaded

and

time for constructive debate must be restricted.

This directly contradicts the statement.

IELTS Trick

Restricted debate = not enough time.

Question 37

Using a committee structure would ensure that board members are fully informed about significant issues.

Answer: NO

Why is this answer correct?

The passage says committees may result in:

the board as a whole being less involved.

Therefore, committee structures do not guarantee full awareness.

IELTS Trick

Less involvement = opposite of fully informed.

Question 38

Before 2008, non-executive directors were at a disadvantage because of their lack of _____.

Answer: information

Why is this answer correct?

The passage says executives had access to: information that part-time non-executive directors lacked.

Vocabulary Connection

Lack = absence.

Question 39

Boards tend to place too much emphasis on _____ considerations that are only short-term in relevance.

Answer: financial

Why is this answer correct?

The passage states:

concentrate too much on short-term financial metrics.

Matching Words

Question	Passage
short-term considerations	short-term financial metrics

IELTS Trick

Metrics → considerations.

Question 40

On certain matters, such as pay, the board may have to accept the views of _____.

Answer: shareholders

Why is this answer correct?

The passage explains shareholders gained stronger powers regarding executive pay and remuneration policies.

Vocabulary Connection

Shareholder = person owning shares in a company.

Common Trap

Many students write:

- investors

But the official IELTS answer is:

shareholders